Volume XX
Number One Hundred Ninety One
September/October 2002



Auto Repair Service Proposal

The Planning Commission held a Public Hearing for a Conditional Use Permit request presented to operate an auto repair service on Third Street East. The request was reviewed. The Planning Commission recommended approval of the Conditional Use Permit with submitted conditions.

The conditions and recommendation from the Planning Commission were reviewed by the council for an auto repair service business. The engineer commented on his concerns regarding proposed improvements in the area. Motion was made and carried with all ayes issuing a Conditional Use Permit for the Third Street business.

Carver Ridge

The Planning Commission held a Public Hearing for rezoning Carver Ridge property. The Planning Commission recommended approval for the rezoning request.

The council discussed regulations regarding home construction in the Carver Ridge development prior to the construction of municipal utilities and streets. The attorney commented that it was a common occurrence in a new subdivision. The Fire Chief had surveyed the area and it was his opinion that a fire truck could not reach this area if necessary. Weather conditions would dictate hazards to other areas. The Fire Chief reminded that the Fire Code only permits one home until streets and utilities are completed. The engineer stated that hydrants are in place. Completion of the streets was anticipated to be mid-August. Motion was made and carried to deny building permits in Carver Ridge until utilities and streets have been approved.

The council reviewed information concerning the fifty one lot preliminary plat and rezoning for the Carver Ridge 2nd property. Motion was made and carried adopting the resolution approving the preliminary plat and one out lot of Carver Ridge 2nd addition, as well as rezoning from agricultural to residential.

Motion was made and carried adopting resolution approving the plans and specifications and ordering advertisement of bids for Carver Ridge area lift station.

Town Line Road

The council was told that work on County Road #147 is scheduled to begin this fall.

Hidden Bluff

The City Planner explained to the Planning Commission that Klingelhutz Development has requested approval for the final plat of Hidden Bluff, formerly Carver South. The preliminary plat had been approved as "Carver South". The Planner recommended approval with conditions.

The council was told about name changes, gave other background information to the council and told them that the park dedication would be in monetary terms.

The engineer talked with the council regarding the issues of the bluff line and existing storm sewer. These things should be addressed presently since it will be more expensive in the future. The council consensus was that the engineer work with the developer resolving the storm sewer and erosion issues. Council member voiced discontent regarding not requiring a turn around on 7th Street for this subdivision. The issue was discussed further. Motion was made and carried with four ayes and one nay adopting resolution approving the final plat for ten units of town homes and one out lot for Hidden Bluff.

The council discussed approval of construction site erosion control contract with Carver Soil and Water Conservation District for Hidden Bluff. It was pointed out that this is a trial agreement. The developer will be responsible for fees involved for inspections. Motion was made and carried with all ayes to enter into the agreement with the Soil and Water Conservation District for review and site inspection services for Hidden Bluff.

Carver North

The council discussed updates for the plans for Carver North since last year. Solutions had been worked out for issues addressed originally with proposal from last year. The updated proposal was tentatively scheduled to be brought to the Planning Commission. Feedback was requested so that the developer would know whether or not they were on the right course.

Fire Station

The administrator stated that it appears that the city does not have an ordinance on the topic pertaining to alcohol in the fire station. Comment was also made that alcohol abuse is not occurring in the Fire Department. The Fire Chief related that this issue had been addressed several years ago. Question was asked how this issue related and impacts insurance costs.

The insurance response to the question of alcohol on the premises under lock and key was stated to have no impact on the city's insurance premium.

Carver Creek

Orrin Thompson Homes also presented request for their final plat approval for Carver Creek 5th Addition. Approval of this final plat with conditions was also recommended by the Planning Commission.

Retaining Walls built in the Carver Creek Subdivision were discussed by the council. The Public Works Director stated his concern regarding water rising to the high water mark by the holding ponds and these retaining walls being submerged in water. With recent storms these concerns were becoming realities. If these walls collapse, whose responsibility are they was asked. The city attorney stated that this would be the homeowner's responsibility. An ordinance would be the best solution for this type of situation. Homeowners inquired if present retaining walls would have to be altered if an ordinance were put into place. Regulations will be needed for future construction of retaining walls.

Carver Creek 5th addition was discussed at the council meeting. There will be twenty three lots. Agreement was reached that bluff line and trees will be off limits. Inquiry was made regarding the X-cel easement under the power lines. The engineer explained that no permanent structures could be built in the 100 foot easement. The Planning Commission had recommended an additional sidewalk be placed in the addition. The engineer explained a proposed mapping fee increase incorporated into the Developer's Agreement. Motion was made and carried with all ayes adopting resolution approving the final plat of twenty three residential lots and three outlots on Carver Creek 5th Addition for Orrin Thompson homes.

Public Works Reports

Public Works Director informed the council of problems with lawn mowers. The council discussed Park and Recreation involvement with city owned equipment.

The city engineer recommended the installation of a catch basin at the Lions Park parking lot to correct a water problem. The Lions would help pay to correct this problem.

The seasonal help for the city of Carver by Dan Schultz and Keith Goetze was reported to have been an excellent job again this year.

Each player must accept the cards life deals him or her; but once they are in hand, he or she alone must decide how to play the cards in order to win the game. - Voltaire

City Planner

The council reviewed a proposal from Yaggy Colby Associates which is one firm interested in the contracting with the city for the city planner consultant contract. The city attorney's suggestion was that the Planning Commission become involved in the process of interviewing prospective companies for city planning.

The attorney updated the council on the processes for proposed city planner. Planning firms had been contacted by the administrator. Resource Strategies gave a brief presentation having worked with several cities in the county. Council member was of the opinion that the Planning Commission should interview for the planning firms and submit recommendation to the council.

The Planning Commission reviewed applicants for city planner opening. Four firms were presently under consideration. They were Resource Strategies Corp; Yaggy Colby Associates; Dahlgren, Shardlow and Uban, Inc and McCombs Frank Roose Associates, Inc. The Planning Commission would review these firms and information submitted prior to submitting a recommendation to the council.

Public Works/Fire Station Building Proposal

The council was told about the City Facilities Advisory Committee meeting. Three options had been voted on. Those options were one; a new Public Works Building and renovate the Fire Station; two; a new Fire Station and renovate the current Fire Station for the Public Works and three; a combination building. A lease purchase proposal was also discussed, but the council would have the final decision. The financial advisor talked about financial options available. Option three, the most logical, was the mayor's opinion since the other options would not meet the city needs and would need resolutions in a few years again. A motion was made but failed to put the issue on the ballot as a referendum.

Building Inspector

Administrator wanted to forward notice terminating the contract with the Building Inspector. The inspector had sent a letter to the council concerning the termination of her contract. The new building inspector, Ray Williams was introduced to the council. The council asked that Ms Salzl be invited to the meeting in order to thank her for her services.

"People have to talk about something just to keep their voice boxes in working order so they'll have good voice boxes in case there's ever anything really meaningful to say"

- Kurt Vonnegut Jr

Carver Lions

The Carver Lions want to take this opportunity to thank everyone who helped and brought business to the Food/Beer Tent and other activities for SteamBoat Days!!! Again, SteamBoat Days was a great success!!!! Thank you to ALL who helped!

The Village Hall façade has been completed and looks great. Be sure to thank the Lions for this nice improvement to the Village Hall. This was a Lion's project to make structures in downtown Carver much more appealing. It certainly looks nice! Thanks!! Soon, the electronic message sign will be put up. This will be available to citizens for advertising.

The next event that the Lions are preparing for is the Annual Halloween Party. It is scheduled for October 26th from 5 PM to 7 PM at the Village Hall. There will be of course, costumes, games, prizes and naturally for best costume, there is a cash prize. This party is for preschoolers through fifth grade. The 'lil' ones can get into the party by bringing a non-perishable food item (for the food shelf) and $2.00 per person.

With these kinds of events occurring there is always help needed and volunteers. If you are interested in helping in any way, you can contact the Chairperson, Karen Rae Huerd at 952) 890-6160. She'll be more than happy to assign some fun chore for you to do. The kids do enjoy this event so much and it's a fun, safe event.

Around-The-Town Concierge/Errand & Pet Service

Around-The-Town provides quality service for busy people in order to enhance your personal and professional lives by doing your run around errand for you while you're busy doing something else.

Too busy of a schedule to do it all alone? Call us for that extra set of hands needed from time to time. Special upcoming party? Need two dozen more hands? That's what we are here for. Call us. Special plan? Not enough time? We can help All you have to do is ask. Some of the services we provide are: special events/occasion assistance, concierge service, personal assistant, general errands, grocery/retail shopping, business services.

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You'd be surprised – our fees are reasonable to make your life just a little bit less hectic and /or less stressful. Check us out.

Pam can be reached at 612) 865-8291 or visit her website at around-the-townLLC.com or e-mail Pam at: aroundthetown@mn.rr.com

Village Hall

Thank you to the Carver Lions for the terrific looking building as you come into town. Quite a change from the cement blocks eh? It looks fantastic! Be sure to let them know it's appreciated and if you think it looks good.

SteamBoat Day's Fire Works

Many of the people who were in Carver celebrating the 150th anniversary SteamBoat Days commented on the '*fantastic*' fire works! They were 'awesome' was one comment. They were better than Belle Plaine was another comment. They were superb. They were absolutely the greatest. So to the people responsible for this fantastic display, THANKS!!!!

Fire Department Highlights and Community Calendar

October 2002

October 1st - Happy Anniversary Paul and Yvonna!
October 3rd - Heritage Preservation Commission Meeting
Drill Night 6:30 PM
October 7th - Council Meeting
- Happy Anniversary Kari and Guy!
October 11th - Happy Anniversary Paul and Gwen!
Happy Birthday Ryan!
October14th - Park and Recreation Board Meeting
Columbus Day Observed
October 15th - Happy Birthday Andrea!
October 19h - Happy Birthday Annette!
October 21st - Council Meeting
Happy Birthday Larry!
Fire Drill 6:30 PM
October 22nd - Planning Commission Meeting
October 26th - Happy Birthday Carl!
October 27th - DayLight Saving Time Ends
October 29th - Happy Anniversary Mom and Dad!
October 30th - Fire Department Meeting Night
October 31st - Halloween

Tentative Agenda

October 7th - Monday Evening 6:30 PM

1) Call to Order
2) Approve Agenda
3) Consent Agenda
4) Pubic Safety
5) Public Utilities/Public Works
6) City Engineer/City Planner
7) Administrative Services
8) Liaison Reports
9) Other Business
10) Adjourn

Comprehensive Plan

The Park and Recreation Board and the engineer's representative reviewed the Comprehensive Plan regarding parks, trails and recreation element. The Park and Recreation Board reviewed the revised chapter concerning these issues and a few proposed changes were made. A skating rink was talked about. They also talked about the trail connection for Broadway and Sixth Street and the Lions Park.

Police Contract

The council discussed the proposed Police Contract for 2003 services. Council member was of the opinion that more information on the department's schedule and activities in the city should be presented to the council. The deputy explained a new program to the city regarding targeting trouble areas/times above and beyond contracted hours. Suggestion was submitted that the candidates running for the sheriff's position be invited to talk to the council. The city needs to review affordability of increasing patrol times. Administrator was directed to schedule and invite the sheriff to the council meeting.

Sheriff Olson was at the council meeting to discuss the 2003 Contract. The mayor inquired what it would cost to increase the patrol time in the city. Two department personnel accompanied the sheriff to answer questions. Contracting between the County, Townships and cities began in 1968. The council inquired about the assigned patrol time for the city and where the officer patrols. The city was told that a log sheet to track this has been implemented. Council member still had concerns for accountability of hours spent in the city that are paid for. The issue will be discussed further.

Question was asked about when the Community Services Officers services would be in place. This process has been slowed down by communities who have not committed for the program. Presently the processes in place are to refine the project. The County Commissioner, Tracy Swanson was at the council meeting to discuss the issue commenting that it is necessary to ensure that the right things are being done. Each community has been invited to meetings to talk about Community Services Officers.

The council discussed daily patrol hours. One council member felt that the contract hours should be increased. Another council member argued that until the time could be accounted for, it should not be increased. It was reported that there are seventeen deputies covering seventy six square miles and over seventy thousand residents. Accountability was brought up again. The sheriff was of the opinion that besides the call itself, the time to write the report would also be counted as patrol time. In the future were there any plans to be able to report accountability? The plan was to discuss this issue in the fall. The contract should be tabled at this time, but the opinion of one council member was still to increase patrolling. The mayor requested the sheriff to return with information to explain the city's contracted hours.

Church By the River

The council discussed the issue of the Church By the River. The Lions are interested in helping to rejuvenate and renovate the interior of the structure, but at the present time the club does not have funds for this project. Their resources have been put into the Village Hall façade. Suggestion was made to utilize Rehab Loan Funds. Figures for costs need to be obtained to continue the discussion. The council agreed that the work should be done. The matter will be discussed further.

General Obligation Improvement Bond Sale

The city financial advisor told the council that it was a good time to sell bonds. These monies would be used to finance projects such as the Fourth Street Utility, the Downtown Street Improvement, Sixth Street Pond Improvement, Carver Ridge Lift Station, the Well No# 2 project and the Pump Station project. Motion was made and carried approving the resolution providing for the sale of General Obligation Improvement Bonds.

Bluff Restoration

Citizen was asked how the bluff restoration project was coming. An extension until the end of October for the project was requested. The project was almost completed. The public works director confirmed the restoration was almost completed and there is not any more erosion occurring. Motion was made and carried with all ayes granting extension for the completion of the erosion project.

Parks

The council discussed various park issues. Inquiry was made about signs being put up to help prevent vandalism in the parks. Motion detector lights and getting residents involved were also discussed. Ideas from the Sheriff's Department should also be sought. Several signs had been requested for Depot Park, also. Signs regarding 'Parks close at 10PM' should be placed in all the parks. Suggestion was also submitted to close RiverSide Park to snowmobiles.

2003 Budget

The proposed budget was reviewed and discussed. The numbers did not agree with 2002 budget. These numbers needed to be corrected. The council was reminded that the Preliminary Levy needs to be submitted to the county by the 15th of September. Suggestion was submitted to invite the City Auditor to the meeting. Motion was made and carried scheduling a special meeting to review the 2003 Budget.

The council discussed the budget at great lengths with staff, building inspector, administrator, auditor and fire chief.

"Books are the legacies that a great genius leaves to mankind, which are delivered down from generation to generation as presents to the posterity of those who are yet unborn."

- Joseph Addison

Miscellaneous

The council was told about repairs to a catch basin on the corner of Lime Street and County Road #40. This catch basin had collapsed due to the heavy rains and heavy traffic.

The council member brought the issue of the corner of Lime Street and County Road #40 to the County Commissioners' attention. It was his opinion that while properties in the general vicinity of this intersection were presently for sale that it might be a good time for the county to review solutions for this corner. The Commissioner pointed out that such a venture would be joint because the city and county roads come together in this area.

Public Utilities Superintendent Revering formally thanked Orrin Thompson Homes and Roman Riesgraf for their donations of Japanese Lilac Shrubs at Community Park.

Administrator submitted a suggestion recommending spending limits without council approval except in the cases of emergencies, which would require a written report. The council would consider the notion and discuss the issue further at a later date. Reminder was given several years ago setting approved spending limits. The city attorney presented the council with a Purchasing Procedure Policy for their review. The purpose of the policy is to establish guidelines relating to the purchase of supplies and services by employees for city business. Motion was made and carried approving the Purchasing Procedure Policy.

Recommendation was submitted by the administrator to approve all new job descriptions for budgeting reasonings. A councilman opposed approval since the wages were not known presently. The attorney was also in opposition.

Bill McMann has trees to donate if Park and Recreation Board personnel would come and get them.

The administrator will be starting the budget work and meeting with the auditor. The council also needs to schedule dates for the Truth In Taxation Hearing. The council tentatively scheduled the meeting for December 2nd with a continuation meeting on December 16th, if necessary.

The issue of repairing the fence at the Mt Hope Cemetery was brought up again to the council. Bids should be obtained and repairs made. The staff was to check into this issue.

The council held a Public Hearing on the ordinance regarding fences, hedges and retaining walls, along with drainage and utility easements. The council made a motion which was carried with all ayes adopting the amended ordinance.

'A kiss is a lovely trick designed by nature to stop speech when words become superfluous.

- Ingrid Bergman

Carver Bluffs

Hans Hagen also presented to the Planning Commission a request for approval of the final plat for Carver Bluffs 7th Addition. The Planning Commission recommended approval of the final plat for the Carver Bluffs 7th Addition.

The City Planner informed the council that the Planning Commission had recommended several more areas for sidewalks in the proposed addition. The City Attorney expressed serious concerns regarding the subdivision continuing in its present manner regarding platting outlots for street improvements and not planning for houses at the same time. The proposal was to put in all the street improvements and then plat the remaining property into six separate outlots with no residential lots. The attorney's recommendation was to deny approval of the plat due to administrative burden. The engineer suggested installation of a turn around. The mayor inquired about erosion control in the development. Another council members concerns involved street warranty issues. The mayor pointed out that there is an ongoing erosion problem in the development. The developer discussed solutions for the controlling erosion problems. Motion was made and carried with four ayes and one nay adopting resolution approving the final plat of zero residential lots and six out lots as Carver Bluffs 7th addition, and that the developer's agreement provide for a three year warranty on the streets.

The engineer discussed the proposed issue of a private well in Carver Bluffs. The Homeowner's Association use for this type of well would be to water public areas such as boulevards, tot lot, etc. The engineer reviewed the pros and cons of the issue. It was the association's plan to use the city's storm water pond for holding water for irrigation. The city attorney commented that an ordinance regarding this situation should be in place as the idea was innovative. The plan will be discussed further.

Township Fire Contracts

The city attorney inquired about the township fire contracts. The attorney pointed out that the township had set their levy in February of 2002 for the year 2003. These new contracts would approximately double the cost of fire protection for the townships. Question has been asked about increasing unit cost for 2003 and using the formula for 2004. The cost difference of the two options was questioned. Council member commented that the city would then be subsidizing the townships. The consensus was that they didn't agree with that option. The issue will be discussed further at another meeting.

The township fire contracts had been revised the attorney told the city. Township Board member informed the council of their opposition to the agreement since it lacked dollar amounts in it. They had been advised by their attorney not to sign the agreement. The city attorney answered questions from the township. The opinion of the townships was that the contracts were not fair to them. No budgeting nor other related paperwork had been shared with the townships. The administrator was directed to send the townships the 2002 budget. Motion was made and carried approving the fire contract as amended.

Municipal Utilities

The Public Works Superintendent informed the council that the second well was being utilized to keep water levels up. The weather had caused problems, but the staff worked hard to keep equipment operating. The Administrator had complained to X-cel regarding electricity.

The council was told that the municipal utilities' use has risen over the year. The Public Works Superintendent told the council of his dissatisfaction with the company who had done work on the manholes. A new company has been sought that is less expensive to complete work on the manholes.

The engineer reported to the council that the temporary pump had been installed and has been used during high peak demand times. Because of the higher capacity in Well No #2, a larger pump with more horsepower was determined to be necessary.

Prices have been received from soil boring companies for the Carver Ridge area lift station. The council reviewed the quotes. Motion was made and carried with all ayes accepting the lowest quote to perform borings for the lift station at Carver Ridge.

The council was told that the sludge pond at the waste water treatment plant is filling up. Applications have been worked on to take care of this situation. Sludge analysis is being done by MN Valley Testing Labs.

The city engineer reviewed issues that the city must deal with concerning the water treatment plant. Carver's water also has a radium issue. Location of the plant was discussed. Type of structure, appearance of the structure and maintenance of area were all talked about. Another citizen inquired about sanitary sewer coming also in the area. The response given was that it was anticipated due to soils that the two utilities would be put in at the same time.

Storm Water

The Public Works Director has completed a summary of the Storm Water Maintenance Program Plan for the council. Some of the procedures the director has already implemented earlier this year. The Public Utilities Supervisor pointed out that the easements behind residences on Sky-View Lane are difficult to maintain the public utilities and storm water systems because fences and the like. Council consensus was that the engineer and the administrator draft a Storm water Maintenance Plan Ordinance for the city.

The League of MN Cities has sent a letter titled "Letter of Understanding" explaining the goal of the Guide Plan providing cities access to the means for completing the permits for storm water. The League is approving a contract with a consultant developing this said Plan. They requested that the city sign this letter stating understanding of this program.

"Painting us very easy when you don't know how, but very difficult when you do."

- Edgar Degas

Sixth Street

The Public Works Director told the council that work has been completed on the pond at Sixth Street. The ponds should be operating properly now.

The Public Works Director and the engineer addressed the issue regarding "No Truck" signage on west Sixth Street. The sign had been placed prior to upgrading to a nine ton design. Suggestion was submitted to announce truck usage in newsletters. However, it was the opinion of a council member that the street should be posted for designed nine ton usage. The council was also reminded how difficult it is for a truck to turn west onto Highway #212 from County Road #40. Council consensus was to remove the "No Trucks" sign on Sixth Street. The administrator was directed to notify the individual who called about the trucks on Sixth Street and explain the situation.

A petition was presented to the council concerning residents who wish to have truck traffic stopped on Sixth Street. It was the citizens opinion that the "No Trucks" signs be put back or more patrol on the street. The engineer explained the nine ton design of the street. It was commented pertaining to the number of springs in the area. The signs were removed because an ordinance is not in place to enforce no trucks on the road. One council member commented that he did not oppose restrictions on the street. Statement was also made that the construction of County Road #147/Town Line Road would alleviate a lot of truck traffic on Sixth Street.

DNR Property

The city planner and the DNR have had discussions regarding acquisitions for park purposes. Discussions have involved the DNR's plans for property in the Carver area and potential of using some of these lands adjacent to the city for active park usage. During these discussions, it was learned that there are two parcels west on County Road #45 that the DNR may not want to keep. These parcels together equal approximately ninety acres. The Park and Recreation Board are interested in pursuing discussions for these parcels for future use.

The possibility of land exchange is plausible. The Park and Recreation Board suggested trading RiverSide Park for other parcels. The Council was asked if they were in favor of this idea or not. This type of acquisition to process takes a long time and if the city was not in agreement, the board needed to be aware of that fact. The council's consensus was to consider the proposition.

Rick Schultz from the Fish and Wildlife Service discussed the RiverSide Park boundaries with the Park and Recreation Board.

Accountant Consultant

The administrator had interviewed individuals for accounting consultant position. An individual would be a consultant working approximately twenty hours per week at $20. per hour. Motion was made and carried entering into the contract for services.

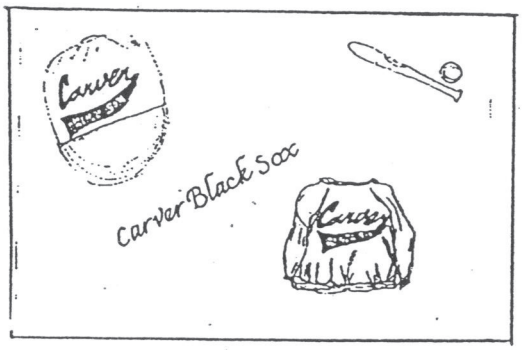
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Looking for a good vehicle? There is a 1995 Silverado Pick Up for sale. It is in excellent condition. Low 80's mileage, two wheel drive and dark blue.

Want to know more, call Karen or Ron at 952) 448-4962. They are asking $10000. or best offer.

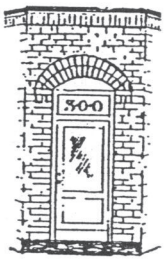
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